

# Team Project Paper

BUAD-304 | Organizational Behavior and Leadership

Instructor: Christine El Haddad

Term: Fall 2026

## Assignment Summary

|                |            |
|----------------|------------|
| Grade weight:  | 15%        |
| Start date:    | 2026-08-31 |
| Due date:      | 2026-11-09 |
| Group project: | Yes        |

## Course Schedule (due dates)

- Due: 2026-10-19 | M Teams Part 1 Textbook Reading: Ch. 8 10/19 Team project outline due ARES Reading: • Coutu, D. (2009). Why teams don't work. • Duhigg, C. (2016). What Google Learned from its Quest to Build
- Due: 2026-11-09 | refer? 9 -- 9 of 16 -- M Team Project Team project paper due (one 11/9 Presentations submission per team). Presentation slides are due on 11/9 before class. W Veteran's Day - No Class 11/11

## Course Schedule (dated sessions)

- 2026-08-26 | 8/26 Attitudes & ARES Reading: Park, N. & Peterson, C. Character Strengths Ethics (2009) Character Strengths: Research and assessment in class. Practice Other: Watch the USC-CT and Case Analysis videos at this link. M Individual Textbook Re
- 2026-09-23 | 9/23 Exercise: 12 Angry Men M Communica- Textbook Reading: Ch. 9 & 10.1-10.4 Team project proposal & team
- 2026-10-07 | 10/7 M Team Project
- 2026-10-12 | 10/12 Workshop I W Midterm
- 2026-10-14 | 10/14 Exam 8 -- 8 of 16 -- M Teams Part 1 Textbook Reading: Ch. 8 10/19 Team project outline due ARES Reading: • Coutu, D. (2009). Why teams don't work. • Duhigg, C. (2016). What Google Learned from its Quest to Build the Perfect Team.
- 2026-10-28 | 10/28 Community Dimensions of Diversity E xercise Stereotypes and Attribution Processes Note: Class meets in the classroom M Team Project
- 2026-11-02 | 11/2 Workshop II W Organiza- Textbook Reading: Ch. 14 & 15 In-class exercise: Map a
- 2026-11-16 | 11/16 E xercise W Team Project Self and peer evaluation due 11/18 Presentations M In-class Video Assignment: Complete the video Before class, your team needs
- 2026-11-30 | 11/30 -tional ARES Reading: Cummings, T. (1995). Change From Programmed Change to Self-Design: Learning How to Change Organizations. Assessment(s): • Self-Assessment 16.02: What Is Your Readiness for Change? • Self-Assessment 16.03: Assessi

## Related Mentions

- M Team Project Team project paper due (one
- 11/9 Presentations submission per team).
- Presentation slides are due on
- 11/9 before class.
- W Veteran's Day - No Class
- 11/11
- M Meta-4 Note: Class meets in the ELC
- 11/16 Exercise
- W Team Project Self and peer evaluation due
- 11/18 Presentations
- M In-class Video Assignment: Complete the video Before class, your team needs
- 11/23 Exercise: interviews of the Omega executives PRIOR to assign each team member to
- Omega to class using this link. interview several of the 9
- Systems Omega Systems executives.
- Have at least 2 people
- interview each executive so
- you do not miss any details.
- Make sure that everyone gets
- interviewed. Bring your
- interview notes to class to
- assist in the exercise.
- W Thanksgiving Break - No Class
- 11/25
- M Organizational Textbook Reading: Ch. 16
- 11/30 -tional ARES Reading: Cummings, T. (1995).
- Change From Programmed Change to Self-Design:
- Learning How to Change Organizations.
- Assessment(s):
- • Self-Assessment 16.02: What Is Your
- Readiness for Change?
- • Self-Assessment 16.03: Assessing Your
- Resistance to Change
- W Final Review Bring questions to ask your professor Personal Reflection Paper due
- 12/2 Question Course evaluations to be completed in class.

- Session
- Final Exam MW 4:00 - 5:50pm section:
- Wed., December 9; 4:30pm - 6:30pm
- MW 6:00 - 7:50pm section:
- Wed., December 9; 7pm - 9pm
- 10
- Additional Information
- USC Marshall Critical Thinking Initiative
- The USC Marshall Critical Thinking Initiative is a school-wide effort to improve your critical thinking skills in order to be more successful problem solvers in class and ultimately in the workplace. This means
- that you will engage in a variety of learning activities in your courses which are aimed at developing and
- applying your critical thinking skills in a disciplined manner so that you can outperform others to get your
- desired job and to further excel in your career. Your ability to think critically is an important part of the
- evaluation/grading process in this course. The centerpiece of Marshall's critical thinking knowledge is a
- website that contains instructional materials and videos. We utilize these resources to prepare you to do the
- case analysis assignments. Here is the link to the website.
- Academic Integrity
- The University of Southern California is foremost a learning community committed to fostering successful
- scholars and researchers dedicated to the pursuit of knowledge and the transmission of ideas. Academic
- misconduct is contrary to this fundamental mission and includes any act of dishonesty in the submission of
- academic work (either in draft or final form), as well as cheating, plagiarism, fabrication (e.g., falsifying
- data), knowingly assisting others in acts of academic dishonesty, and any act that gains or is intended to
- gain an unfair academic advantage. Students are expected to uphold the highest standards of academic
- integrity in all coursework. This course follows the expectations for academic integrity as stated in the USC
- Student Handbook. All students are expected to submit assignments that are original work and prepared
- specifically for the course/section in this academic term. Students may not submit work written by others

- or "recycle" work prepared for other courses without obtaining written permission from the instructor(s).
- Students suspected of academic misconduct will be reported to the Office of Academic Integrity.
- Academic dishonesty has a far-reaching impact and is considered a serious offense against the university.
- Violations will result in a grade penalty, such as a failing grade on the assignment or in the course, and
- disciplinary action from the university, such as suspension or expulsion. For more information about
- academic integrity see the Student Handbook, the Office of Academic Integrity's website, and university
- policies on Research and Scholarship Misconduct. Please ask your instructor if you are unsure what
- constitutes unauthorized assistance on an exam or assignment or what information requires citation and/or
- attribution.
- Instructors determine whether and how generative AI tools (such as ChatGPT, Copilot, Claude, Gemini,
- and similar applications) and other external resources (such as English-language translation tools) may be
- used in this course. Expectations may vary from assignment to assignment. This includes AI tools that
- record, transcribe, or summarize class sessions, which may require express instructor permission.
- Review
- the AI use guidance provided carefully, and direct any questions to your instructor before submitting work.
- Students seeking general guidance may consult the following resources:
- • USC Student Handbook
- • Generative AI General Policy
- • Practical Tips for Using AI in Academic Work
- • Office of Academic Integrity
- Statement Around Use of AI Tools
- Since creating, analytical, and critical thinking skills are part of the learning outcomes of this course, all
- assignments should be prepared by the student working individually or in groups. Students may not have
- another person or entity complete any substantive portion of the assignment. Developing strong
- competencies in these areas will prepare you for a competitive workplace. Additionally, adding copyrighted
- case content to an LLM such as ChatGPT is a violation of our case publisher Harvard University's terms
- of use and copyright. Therefore, using AI tools is prohibited in this course, will be identified as plagiarism,
- and will be reported to the Office of Academic Integrity.

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- Add/Drop Process
- Most Marshall classes are open enrollment (R-clearance) through the Add deadline. If there is an open seat,
- you can add the class using Web Registration. If the class is full, you will need to continue checking Web
- Registration or the Schedule of Classes to see if a space becomes available. Students who do not attend the
- first two class sessions (for classes that meet twice per week) or the first class meeting (for classes that meet
- once per week) may be dropped from the course. Therefore, let me know if you have any conflicts in Week
- 1 like visa or health issues so you aren't dropped. There are no formal wait lists for Marshall undergraduate
- courses, and professors cannot add students or increase the course capacity. If all sections of the course are
- full, you can add your name to an interest list by contacting the Office of Undergraduate Advising & Student
- Affairs; if new seats or sections are added, students on the interest list will be notified.
- Statement on Technology Use
- I expect you to be responsible in using technology in class. You will need to "be here and be present" so
- that we can create an engaging learning community. It is far more important to participate in class than to
- take detailed notes. Course powerpoint slides and class recordings will be posted to Brightspace. After
- each class session, you may want to take some time to reflect on the learning experience and type up
- whatever notes seem useful.
- Videotaping faculty lectures is not permitted due to copyright infringement regulations. Audiotaping may
- be permitted if approved by the professor. Use of any recorded or distributed material is reserved
- exclusively for the USC students registered in this class. Exceptions to this policy may be granted to
- individual students with appropriate documentation on a case-by-case basis.
- Use of Recordings
- Pursuant to the USC Student Handbook (<https://policy.usc.edu/studenthandbook/>, pages 16 and 59),
- distribution or use of notes, recordings, exams, or other intellectual property, based on university classes or
- lectures without the express permission of the instructor for purposes other than individual or group study

- is prohibited. This includes but is not limited to providing materials for distribution by services publishing
- course materials. This restriction on unauthorized use also applies to any information, created by another,
- distributed to students, or in any way had been displayed for use in relationship to the class, whether
- obtained in class, via email, on the internet, or via any other method. Distributing course material without
- the instructor's permission will be presumed to be an intentional act to facilitate or enable academic
- dishonesty and is strictly prohibited. Violations of this policy may subject an individual or entity to
- Team Project
- You will work with your team throughout the semester to prepare for and complete the Team Project. The
- goals of the team project are (1) to enrich your understanding of organizations and leadership; (2) to provide
- you with an opportunity to apply what you have learned in the course; (3) to assess your ability to analyze
- an organization or organizations and come to insightful conclusions and (4) to help you develop critical
- interpersonal and teamwork skills.
- Your team will have a choice of conducting either:
- 1. A fieldwork study with a local organization such as a student organization, business unit on campus, or
- other local company. Your team will investigate and analyze some aspect of this organization that
- connects with themes in the course such as the organization's culture, rewards system or the structure
- and functioning of groups within the organization. You will identify best practices and make
- recommendations based on your study.
- 4
- 2. An issue analysis of an issue/topic connected to the themes in the course and of importance to multiple
- organizations; this issue may be inspired by something in the headlines of the business press or
- something in your own experience. You will need to examine the nature of this issue and analyze in
- detail how different companies have addressed and/or experienced the issue. You will identify best
- practices and make recommendations based on your study using archival sources (i.e. library research).
- Your "deliverable" for this project has five components:
- 1. Project proposal with team contract
- 2. Detailed outline of paper
- 3. Project paper
- 4. In-class presentation followed by Q&A

- 5. Self & peer evaluation feedback (online assessment explained in class).
- Submitted assignments should use 12-point, Times New Roman font, double-spaced, with 1-inch margins
- on all sides.
- Feedback helps you learn and improve your performance as well as the quality of your output as a team.
- As part of the team project, you will practice and develop skills in providing and receiving effective
- feedback through in-class exercises and a more formal peer evaluation survey. The criteria for the peer
- evaluation will be discussed in class and posted to Brightspace.
- The final grade for this project is based on four components: the project proposal, the project paper, the
- presentation, and the self & peer evaluation. The team project will be evaluated based on the quality of the
- analysis, the appropriate use of course concepts, principles and frameworks, the logic and substantiation of
- conclusions, the clarity, organization and style of the writing and the quality of your class presentation. The
- detailed outline of the paper is not graded but you will receive feedback to help improve the final paper.
- Further instructions and grading rubrics will be posted to Brightspace.
- Grades for individual student contributions to the team project are assigned by your Professor, based on
- my observations of the team's working dynamics, my assessment of the team project quality, and thoughtful
- consideration of the information provided through your peer evaluations.
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## Full Syllabus Extract

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exam or assignment or what information requires citation and/or attribution. Instructors determine whether and how generative AI tools (such as ChatGPT, Copilot, Claude, Gemini, and similar applications) and other external resources (such as English-language translation tools) may be used in this course. Expectations may vary from assignment to assignment. This includes AI tools that record, transcribe, or summarize class sessions, which may require express instructor permission. Review the AI use guidance provided carefully, and direct any questions to your instructor before submitting work. Students seeking general guidance may consult the following resources: • USC Student Handbook • Generative AI General Policy • Practical Tips for Using AI in Academic Work • Office of Academic Integrity Statement Around Use of AI Tools Since creating, analytical, and critical thinking skills are part of the learning outcomes of this course, all assignments should be prepared by the student working individually or in groups. Students may not have another person or entity complete any substantive portion of the assignment. Developing strong competencies in these areas will prepare you for a competitive workplace. Additionally, adding copyrighted case content to an LLM such as ChatGPT is a violation of our case publisher Harvard University's terms of use and copyright. Therefore, using AI tools is prohibited in this course, will be identified as plagiarism, and will be reported to the Office of Academic Integrity. 11

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**Team Project** You will work with your team throughout the semester to prepare for and complete the Team Project. The goals of the team project are (1) to enrich your understanding of organizations and leadership; (2) to provide you with an opportunity to apply what you have learned in the course; (3) to assess your ability to analyze an organization or organizations and come to insightful conclusions and (4) to help you develop critical interpersonal and teamwork skills. Your team will have a choice of conducting either: 1. A fieldwork study with a local organization such as a student organization, business unit on campus, or other local company. Your team will investigate and analyze some aspect of this organization that connects with themes in the course such as the organization's culture, rewards system or the structure and functioning of groups within the organization. You will identify best practices and make recommendations based on your study. 4

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